

MONCHO UNSCHOOLING

American Football

Unit Study

“Step onto the field and discover that every snap, spiral and touchdown is a hidden science lab, math puzzle and team story all at once.”

Physics | Math | Movement & Body | History | Language Arts | Art & Creativity | Life Skills & SEL | Biology | Geography | Music

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🧭 **How to use this guide:** This is not a workbook, and there's no answer key — on purpose! Every challenge is an invitation. Pick the ones that spark curiosity, skip the rest, and go find the answers by doing. **AI plans. Kids DO.** 🚀

🏈 PHYSICS

Every throw, tackle and cleat print on the field is a physics experiment waiting for you to test it.

🌀 Challenge 1: Spiral vs. Wobble

🎯 Testing Variables

Why does a spinning ball fly so differently from a tumbling one? ❓

1. Grab a soft football or roll up a pair of socks into a tight ball. Mark a throwing line outside with chalk or a towel.
2. Throw with a spiral: grip the ball, snap your wrist, and make it spin around its long axis. Throw it 5 times.
3. Throw it again 5 times with a wobble: toss it end over end with no spin. A rolled-up sock ball is easiest to wobble.
4. After each throw, measure how far it landed in big steps and note if it drifted left or right.
5. Draw a quick sketch of each flight path: straight, curved or tumbling.

Why: a spiral spins around its long axis, which keeps the ball pointing steadily so it slices through the air straighter. This is called gyroscopic stability.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Do only 3 throws of each kind and count steps without worrying about exact left or right drift.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Find the average distance of your spirals and your wobbles, then figure out how many steps farther the spiral flies on average.

🚗 Challenge 2: Crash-Test Collision

🎯 Momentum

What happens to a block when something heavy hits it slowly, and what changes when it hits fast? ❓

You're the crash-test engineer for a toy company, and your job is to find out how speed changes a collision.

1. Make a ramp by propping a flat board or big book on a pile of 2 books.
2. Place a block or small box at the bottom of the ramp as your crash target.
3. Let a toy car roll down from a low spot on the ramp, then from the middle, then from the top. Each time, measure how far the block slides.
4. Try it again with a heavier car, or tape a coin on top of your car.
5. Record which combination of speed and weight pushed the block farthest.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Use just two ramp heights, low and high, and notice which one pushes the block farther.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Predict how far the block will slide for a ramp height you haven't tested yet, then test it to see how close you were.

👟 Challenge 3: Cleats or Smooth Soles?

🎯 Measuring Friction

Why can't a player in smooth shoes push off the ground as well as one with studs? ❓

Players' cleats have studs on the bottom to grip grass and turf and help them push off without slipping. Put that grip to the test.

1. Find two shoes: one with a bumpy, gripping sole and one with a smooth sole.
2. Tie a string or loop a rubber band around each shoe, then hook a spring scale to it. If you don't have a scale, notice how far the rubber band stretches.
3. Pull each shoe slowly across grass, then carpet, then tile.
4. Write down the scale reading, or measure the rubber band's stretch with a ruler, for every shoe and surface.
5. Which combination was hardest to drag? Which slid easiest?

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Test just one grippy shoe and one smooth shoe on only two surfaces, and compare which was harder to pull.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add a third shoe, such as a sandal, and rank all your shoes from most grip to least grip on each surface.

🏈 MATH

Every yard line, point and down on a football field is a number waiting to be solved.

🏈 Challenge 1: Build Your Own Field

🎯 Measurement

How many of your own steps would it take to walk from one end zone to the other?❓

A regulation NFL field is 120 yards long including two 10-yard end zones, and 53 1/3 yards wide (160 feet). Let's shrink it to fit your driveway or living room!

1. Decide that 1 of your steps = 1 yard.
2. Use tape or chalk to mark the starting end line.
3. Walk 10 steps and mark the goal line, then 100 more steps for the other goal line, then 10 more for the back of the second end zone. Count out loud as you go.
4. Mark every 10 steps with a short line, like real yard lines.
5. Calculate: how many steps is it from end zone to end zone? Check it against your count.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Use a 50-step mini field (1 step = 2 yards) and mark only the goal lines and the middle.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Figure out the width of the field in steps, then multiply length × width to find the total area in square yards.

🏈 Challenge 2: Scoreboard Detective

🎯 Addition & Multiplication

Can you figure out the final score when the only clues are how the points were scored? ❓

You're the stadium scorekeeper, and the scoreboard just broke! Use the points below to rebuild the final scores. A touchdown is worth 6 points, an extra-point kick 1 point, a two-point conversion 2 points, a field goal 3 points, and a safety 2 points.

1. Mystery Game A: 3 touchdowns, each followed by an extra-point kick. What's the score?
2. Mystery Game B: 2 touchdowns (one with an extra point, one with a two-point conversion) and 2 field goals.
3. Mystery Game C: 1 touchdown with an extra point, 3 field goals and 1 safety.
4. Now invent two mystery games of your own for someone else to solve.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Only use touchdowns (6) and field goals (3), and count by sixes and threes on your fingers.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Find all the different ways a team could score exactly 20 points.

🏈 Challenge 3: Four Downs to Glory

🎯 Addition & Subtraction

How many first downs can you earn while marching the ball down the field? ❓

An offense gets 4 downs to move the ball 10 yards. If they succeed, they earn a new set of 4 downs.

1. Draw a yardage tracker: a line numbered 0 to 100 on paper, with a coin as your ball.
2. Roll a die each down. Odd number: gain that many yards. Even number: lose 1 yard (a tackle in the backfield!).
3. Start at your own 20. Track your total yards gained on each set of downs.
4. If you gain 10 or more yards within 4 downs, it's a first down! Mark that spot and start a fresh set of 4 downs from there.
5. Keep playing until you score a touchdown at 100 or run out of downs. How many first downs did you earn?

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Only gain yards (no losses) and move the first-down marker 5 yards instead of 10.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Roll two dice and add them for each play, and track your average yards per play across the whole drive.

🏃 MOVEMENT & BODY

Football is a full-body sport, so every throw, pull, cut and kick is a chance to train like a real player.

🏈 Challenge 1: Rookie Training Camp Circuit

🎯 Coordination

How good can you get at three totally different football skills in just one afternoon?❓

You're the rookie at training camp, and the coach wants to see what you've got, with no tackling allowed.

1. Set a laundry basket or hula hoop 5 big steps away. Throw a soft ball or rolled-up socks at it 5 times and count the hits.
2. Tuck a dish towel into your waistband like a flag. Ask a family member to run past while you try to pull theirs, then swap. Count your pulls in 3 tries.
3. Place 5 shoes or cones in a zigzag, 2 steps apart. Weave through as fast as you can while a helper times you.
4. Do the whole circuit twice and write your best score for each station.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Stand just 3 steps from the hoop and walk through the cones instead of running.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add a fourth station, such as catching a gentle toss while jogging, and try to beat your own score on a second day.

🥅 Challenge 2: Kick Between the Uprights

🎯 Balance and Aim

What does your body have to do, in what order, to send a ball exactly where you want? ❓

Real goal posts are shaped like a giant "Y." Let's make a mini version.

1. Set two cones (or water bottles) about 4 big steps apart, like the uprights.
2. Stand 5 steps back, holding your arms out for balance. Practice the motion without a ball: one small step back, one step to the side, then a smooth swing of your kicking leg, finishing with your toes pointed.
3. Say the steps out loud as you move, like a dance count: "back, side, swing, point!"
4. Now kick a soft ball or balled-up socks through the cones 10 times. Make a tally mark for each hit.

Why: Your standing foot and your arms keep you steady while your hips and leg swing, so a smooth, same-every-time motion sends the ball in the same direction.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Move the cones farther apart and stand 3 steps back.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Move back one step after every 3 hits and see how far back you can still score.

🔥 Challenge 3: The Team Warm-Up Dance

🎯 Flexibility

Which parts of a football player's body work the hardest, and how would you get them ready? ❓

You're the team trainer, and the big game starts in 10 minutes. Your players need a warm-up they'll actually enjoy.

1. List the body parts players use most: legs, arms, shoulders, hips and neck.
2. Invent one move or stretch for each, such as big arm circles for throwing or high knees for sprinting.
3. Give each move a fun name, like "The Quarterback Windmill."
4. Put the moves in order and hold each for 8 counts.
5. Teach the full routine to your family or stuffed animals, then lead it from start to finish.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Choose just three body parts and hold each move for 4 counts.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add a favorite song with a steady beat and match each move to the rhythm.

📜 HISTORY

Long before helmets and Super Bowls, American football began as a college experiment, and its rules, its huddle and its heroes all have stories to tell.

📜 Challenge 1: Play the 1869 Game

🎯 Comparing Then and Now

What would football feel like if you were not allowed to throw or carry the ball? ❓

On November 6, 1869, Rutgers played Princeton in New Jersey in the first college football game, and its rules looked closer to soccer than to today's game. Time to invent your own version!

1. Grab a soft ball (or a rolled-up pair of socks) and mark two goal lines with shoes or towels.
2. Make three old-style rules: no throwing, no carrying, kicking and batting only.
3. Play with a friend or family member until someone scores 3 goals.
4. Now add one modern rule, like running with the ball, and play again.
5. Make a two-column chart, "1869 Game" and "Today's Game," and list three differences you felt in your body.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Play with just one rule (kick only) and write down one difference between the two games.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Invent a third set of rules that mixes the best parts of both games, teach it to someone, and ask them to rate it from 1 to 5.

📜 Challenge 2: Walter Camp's Rule Test

🎯 Evaluating Rules

What if football had no line to start from and no limit on tries? ❓

You're on the rules committee in the 1880s. Walter Camp, a Yale player and coach often called the "Father of American Football," wants two big changes: a line of scrimmage and a system of downs. Your job is to decide whether to keep them.

1. Use a soft ball and a small field, with one team trying to carry the ball past a goal line.
2. Round 1, no Camp rules: players crowd around the ball with no starting line and can keep it as long as they like. Play for 5 minutes.
3. Round 2, Camp's rules: start each play with two teams facing each other across a line, and give the offense 4 tries to move forward 5 big steps.
4. Talk it over. Which round was fairer? Which was more fun? Which was easier to follow?

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Test only the line of scrimmage, and give your verdict with a thumbs up or thumbs down.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Invent one new rule of your own, test it, and present your case for or against it to your "committee" of family members.

📜 Challenge 3: The Silent Huddle

🎯 Nonverbal Communication

How could a team share a secret plan while the other side stands right there watching? ❓

The huddle was reportedly invented in the 1890s at Gallaudet University, a school for deaf students. Players signed their plays to each other, and they needed a way to hide those signs from opponents.

1. Find a partner. Make up three silent hand signals, like "run left," "pass," and "fake."
2. Practice each signal until your partner can read it without any words.
3. Stand a few steps apart and signal a play while a third person tries to guess it.
4. Now close your bodies into a tight circle, like the first huddle, and try again. Does the secret stay safer?
5. Switch roles and send a new play.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Use only two signals and keep your partner close.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Combine three signals into one full play, sign the whole thing silently, and see if your partner can act it out correctly.

📝 LANGUAGE ARTS

Football has its own secret language, and every word in it has a story you can tell, shout or write.

📖 Challenge 1: Build Your Own Football Dictionary

🎯 Word Origins

Where do strange football words like "blitz" and "audible" actually come from? ❓

Make your own dictionary of football words. Use real books, a library, or a grown-up's help to look up each word.

1. Fold 3 sheets of paper in half and staple the fold to make a little booklet. Add a cover title.
2. Pick 6 words: blitz, huddle, audible, snap, sack and one more you find yourself.
3. For each word, write a definition in your own funny words, like you're explaining it to a friend who has never seen a game.
4. Look up where each word comes from (an online etymology dictionary or a library book). Write the origin in one line next to it.
5. Draw a tiny picture beside each word.

Why: "blitz" is short for the German word "Blitzkrieg," meaning "lightning war," which is why it describes a fast, surprise rush.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Pick only 4 words, skip the origins, and just write your own fun definition and a picture for each.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add 4 more words and sort your dictionary into groups (offense, defense, and everyday words that left football and entered normal speech, like "Monday-morning quarterback").

🎙️ Challenge 2: Radio Play-by-Play

🎯 Descriptive Language

How can you make someone picture a play just by using your voice? ❓

You're the radio announcer, and listeners can't see a thing. Your words are their eyes!

1. Set up a short backyard play with a friend or family member: a throw, a catch and a run to a cone or shoe.
2. Do the play once and watch closely. What happened first, next and last?
3. Write your call on paper. Use strong action words (zooms, leaps, darts, snatches) and sound words. Add what the crowd might be doing.
4. Practice reading it with your voice rising for exciting parts and slowing down for tense ones.
5. Run the play again while you perform your call out loud. Try to match your words to the action as it happens.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Use only 5 sentences, and pick 3 strong action words from a list before you begin.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add a second announcer who gives the stats and background ("That's the third catch of the day!"), and trade lines back and forth.

📚 Challenge 3: The Team That Never Won

🎯 Story Writing

What would it feel like to play in the biggest game of the year after a whole season of losing? ❓

Write a short story about a team that has never won a game and now faces its big final game. Your team's final game can be as big as the Super Bowl, the NFL championship game.

1. Name your team and give it 3 players, each with a different personality.
2. Write the beginning: show a losing season with a funny or sad moment.
3. Write the middle: something changes before the big game. Maybe a new idea, a lost item or a surprise visitor.
4. Write the ending: what happens at the final game? You decide if they win, lose or something unexpected.
5. Read it aloud and fix any sentence that sounds boring. Add 3 drawings to your pages.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Tell the story in just three parts (beginning, middle, end) with one sentence each, then add a drawing for every part.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Write the story from the point of view of the team's water bottle, mascot or ball, and use at least two similes.

🎨 ART & CREATIVITY

Every great football team starts with a look, a story and a trophy worth chasing, and you get to invent all of them.

🏈 Challenge 1: Logo and Mascot Lab

🎯 Logo design

What makes a picture instantly say "this is our team" without using a single word? ❓

Every team needs a face that fans can spot from across the stadium.

1. Pick your team's name and brainstorm 3 animals or objects that could be your mascot.
2. Choose 2 or 3 team colors and decide what each color stands for (red for courage, gold for shining, and so on).
3. Sketch your logo big and bold with a pencil first. Keep it simple enough to draw in 10 seconds.
4. Trace over it with markers or colored pencils, then draw your mascot next to it.
5. Write 2 sentences on the back telling the story of why you chose that mascot and those colors.

Why: Simple shapes and strong colors are easy for the brain to recognize quickly, which is why you can spot a famous logo even from far away.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Use just one shape for your logo, like a shield or circle, and pick only two colors.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Make a second version of your logo in only one color, so it still works on a black-and-white ticket or a stamp.

🏆 Challenge 2: Build a Championship Trophy

🎯 Sculpting

What would a trophy look like if it could tell the whole story of your team's season?❓

You're the trophy maker, and the champions are arriving tomorrow.

1. Gather clay, aluminum foil, cardboard tubes, bottle caps or other clean recycled bits.
2. Build a sturdy base first, wide and flat so your trophy won't tip over.
3. Stack, shape and press your pieces upward to build the top. Add handles, a football shape or a star if you like.
4. Cover it with foil, paint or marker so it looks shiny and special.
5. Make a small name plate from cardboard or clay and engrave a title on it with a toothpick or pencil tip, like "Best Teamwork Cup" or "Brave Hearts Trophy."

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Build a short, simple trophy from a single piece of clay or a foil-wrapped cup, and write the title with a marker.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add a second tier or a tiny sculpted figure on top, and design a small stand to display it.

🎺 Challenge 3: Gameday From the Stands

🎯 Drawing scenes

How can you show a roaring crowd and a faraway field on one flat piece of paper?❓

Imagine you're sitting high in the stands on a sunny Saturday.

1. Lightly draw a long horizontal line across the page for the field's edge.
2. Draw the field below it as a green shape that looks smaller and narrower at the far end.
3. In the front, draw big fans from behind. Make them larger than the tiny players on the field.
4. Add waving flags, pennants, foam fingers, face paint and a few open mouths cheering.
5. Color it in, using bright colors up close and softer ones far away.

Why: Things that are drawn bigger and lower on the page look closer, and smaller and higher ones look farther away, which gives flat paper a sense of depth.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Draw just a few fans and one flag in front of a simple green field.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add the sky, light clouds, a scoreboard and tiny details like popcorn or banners, and show the crowd in three layers: close, middle and far.

🤝 LIFE SKILLS & SEL

On a football field, eleven players have to trust each other, follow fair rules and handle every win and loss with class.

🤫 Challenge 1: The Silent Pass

🎯 Teamwork

How does it feel when you have to count on your teammates without saying a single word? ❓

A football team puts 11 players on the field at the same time, and none of them can win alone. Now invent a game where your team has to work together in silence.

1. Gather 3 or more family members or friends and a soft ball, a rolled-up pair of socks, or a balled-up towel.
2. Together, invent one rule that makes passing tricky (everyone must touch the ball before it goes back to the first person, or you pass in a zigzag pattern).
3. Play the game with no talking at all. Use only eye contact, nods and gestures.
4. After 5 minutes, sit in a circle and share: When did you feel confident? When did you feel stuck? What helped you understand a teammate?

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Allow one signal word like "ready" and use a big, soft ball that is easy to catch.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add a second ball at the same time, or invent a game where each player has a secret job, then try to guess each other's jobs during the check-in.

🚩 Challenge 2: Flags Up, Fair Play

🎯 Fair Rules

What would a game look like if nobody agreed on the rules? ❓

You are the referee, and the whole family is about to play a game under your watch. Referees use hand signals, like both arms straight up for a touchdown, and throw yellow flags to mark penalties.

1. Look up 4 referee signals in a library book or a kid-friendly football guide, and practice each one in a mirror.
2. Make 3 penalty flags: cut yellow squares from paper or fabric and tie each to a pencil or a rolled-up sheet of paper.
3. Draw a chart with each signal and its meaning.
4. Play a silly family game (like tag or a toss game) with you as the referee. Throw a flag and make the signal each time someone breaks a rule.
5. Afterward, talk: How did it feel to be the one calling fouls? What happened when a call felt unfair?

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Learn only 2 signals and use one flag.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Invent 2 new signals for your family game, then let someone else be referee while you play and see if you respect the calls.

🏅 Challenge 3: Winning and Losing with Class

🎯 Sportsmanship

What are the words that make someone feel respected, whether they won or lost? ❓

Great athletes show that how you act matters as much as whether you win. Winning is exciting and losing can sting, but kind words and a handshake help everyone feel respected.

1. Think of a time you won something big. Write 3 sentences you could say to the other side that are kind and not bragging.
2. Now think of a time you lost something that mattered to you. Write 3 sentences you could say that are honest and respectful.
3. Find a partner. Act out both scenes: one of you is the winner, the other is the loser. Then switch roles.
4. Read both speeches out loud, standing tall, with a handshake at the end.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Write just 1 sentence for each speech and use a sentence starter like "Good game, I liked when you..."

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add a third speech for a tie, or give your speech to a younger family member and ask which words made them feel best.

🧬 BIOLOGY

Your body is the most important player on the field, and it changes in amazing ways every time you run, throw and catch.

🫀 Challenge 1: Heartbeat Detective

🎯 Pulse and Exercise

What does your heart do when your body suddenly needs more energy? ❓

You're the sports scientist, and your own heart is today's subject. You need a timer and a pencil.

1. Sit still for 2 minutes. Press two fingers (not your thumb) on your neck beside your windpipe, or on your wrist below your thumb. Count beats for 15 seconds and multiply by 4. That's your resting rate.
2. Sprint in place or race across the yard for 30 seconds. Right away, count for 15 seconds and multiply by 4.
3. Walk slowly and breathe deeply for 2 minutes. Count and multiply one more time.
4. Write all three numbers in a log, with the time of each reading.

Why: Working muscles use up oxygen fast, so your heart pumps harder and faster to deliver more. When you stop, it slows back down.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Count for a full 60 seconds instead of multiplying, and only measure two moments: resting and right after running.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Repeat the test on a second day, and also log how long your heart takes to return to its resting number. Which day was faster?

🥚 Challenge 2: Crack-Protect an Egg

🎯 Cushioning Impacts

How can a soft layer protect something fragile from a hard crash? ❓

Football helmets have a hard plastic shell with padding inside to spread out and absorb the force of impacts. Your mission is to build a mini version for a hard-boiled egg, which stands in for a very fragile brain.

1. Slide a hard-boiled egg into a zip-top bag and seal it tight.
2. Gather padding: cotton balls, a sponge, bubble wrap, a rolled sock, or paper towels.
3. Build your helmet around the bagged egg with a paper cup, a small plastic container, or tape as a hard shell.
4. Test it. Drop it from a set height, such as waist level, onto grass or a towel.
5. Check the egg. If it survived, drop it from a bit higher. If not, redesign and try again.

Why: Padding squishes slowly, which stretches the crash out over more time and spreads the force over a wider area instead of one sharp spot.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Drop it onto a pillow or a towel from a low height.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Drop an unprotected egg in a bag as your test group, then compare it to your helmet at three different heights. Which padding material protected best?

🗺️ GEOGRAPHY

Football lives in real places, from a college campus in New Jersey to a small city in Wisconsin, and every one of them shows up on the map.

🗺️ Challenge 1: Football Places Map

🎯 Map Reading

If you drew a line from your home to the places where football began and grew up, how far would you travel? ❓

Grab a blank U.S. map (print one or trace the country on plain paper), a pencil, a ruler and an atlas or a free online map.

1. Mark four dots: Rutgers (New Brunswick, New Jersey), Green Bay (Wisconsin), Canton (Ohio) and your own home.
2. Next to Green Bay, write "Founded 1919, fan-owned since 1923." The Packers are the only major U.S. pro team owned by their fans.
3. Look at the map scale and use your ruler to measure the distance between each pair of dots. Write the numbers on the lines.
4. Color the longest line red and the shortest line green. Add a compass rose in one corner.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Mark only three dots (Rutgers, Green Bay and your home) and measure with the edge of a sticky note, counting how many lengths fit between the dots.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add a legend and a scale bar, then use the scale to find the distance from Green Bay to Rutgers in miles and work out how many days a team would need to travel by bus if it covers about 500 miles a day.

🏟️ Challenge 2: Build for the Weather

🎯 Climate and Design

Would you build the same stadium for a snowy city and a scorching one? ❓

Lambeau Field in Green Bay, Wisconsin holds over 80,000 fans, and when they all cheer, the noise can get very loud. Now it's your turn to be the designer.

1. Pick one cold place (like Green Bay) and one hot place (like Phoenix, Arizona). Use an atlas or a weather website to find a typical winter and summer temperature for each.
2. Draw two stadium sketches on paper, one for each place.
3. For each one, choose a roof (open, dome or retractable) and a field (real grass or artificial turf).
4. Write one reason for each choice beside your drawing. Where will fans sit, and how will they stay warm or cool?

Why: Grass needs sunlight and mild weather to grow, while turf and domes work in places that are frozen, baking or rainy.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Design just one stadium, and choose between only two things: dome or no dome.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add a third city of your choice, then rank all three stadiums from most to least expensive to build and explain your ranking.

🎵 MUSIC

Every football game has a beat, from the stomp of cleats to the roar of a marching band after a big play.

🥁 Challenge 1: Stomp, Clap, Pot-Drum Chant!

🎯 Rhythm patterns

How can your hands, feet and a kitchen pot make a whole crowd move together? ❓

Your team needs a fight chant that rattles the bleachers. Grab a pot, a wooden spoon, and a friend or family member to answer you.

1. Make a four-beat pattern: stomp, stomp, clap, pot-drum hit. Repeat it until your body knows it without thinking.
2. Write a 4-word team call, like "Who runs this field?" Chant it on the beat while you keep the pattern going.
3. Have your partner shout the answer back, like "We do! We do!", on the next four beats.
4. Swap parts, then play the whole chant three times in a row, getting louder each time.

Why: a steady beat gives everyone the same "when," so a group can shout or move at exactly the same moment.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Skip the pot. Use just stomp and clap, and keep the call to two words.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add a second pattern for the middle of the chant, such as clap-clap-stomp-pot, and switch between the two without losing the beat.

🎺 Challenge 2: The Touchdown Victory Song

🎯 Composing with repetition

What makes a short song so catchy that everyone is humming it after one play? ❓

You're the marching band leader, and the team just scored! The crowd is waiting for your victory song.

1. Gather 3 "instruments" from home: a jar of dry rice to shake, two spoons to tap, an upside-down bucket to drum, or a rubber band stretched over a box to pluck.
2. Make a repeating beat of 8 counts, for example drum on 1 and 5, spoons on 3 and 7, shaker on the rest.
3. Add a melody by humming or singing a 4-note tune over the beat. Keep it short so it's easy to remember.
4. Write a one-line victory lyric, like "Six points, let's go!", and sing it each time the beat comes around.
5. Perform your song for someone and march while you play.

🌱 **Make it Easier:** Use only two instruments and skip the melody. Just chant your lyric over the beat.

🚀 **Level it Up:** Add a second section with a different beat, like a slower "halftime" part, then bring back the first beat for a big finish.